Optima Academy Online
AN EDUCATION EXPERIENCE COMPANY

Full Year · Grade 9

Algebra 1

OPTIMA ACADEMY ONLINE · COURSE SYLLABUS · 2026–2027

FACILITATOR Optima Academy Online Faculty	EMAIL & OFFICE your.name@optimaed.com · 239.673.2801 (OAO Front Office)
FLORIDA COURSE Florida 1200310 · Full-year course	OFFICE HOURS Posted in Canvas · weekly Study Hall & VR workshops
GRADE LEVEL Grade 9 (High School)	FORMAT On-Demand (also offered live on the VR campus)

About this syllabus. This is the plan for the course as designed. It is a full-year high-school course; On-Demand scholars pace through the eleven modules across the four quarters of their enrolled year. On-Demand and live-school sections share the same content and expectations; exact pacing, scheduled dates, and a few activities may vary from section to section and term to term. Your facilitator will confirm the specifics for your section.

Course Overview

Algebra 1 builds the foundation for all higher mathematics. Across eleven modules, scholars move from the number sense of exponents and radicals into the heart of algebra — solving and modeling with equations, inequalities, and functions. They graph and write linear, absolute value, quadratic, and exponential functions; solve systems; reason with polynomials; and learn to compare families of functions and describe how transformations change them. The year closes with statistical data: representing, analyzing, and interpreting real information to make sound conjectures. Every lesson pairs a short interactive lesson with an Independent Practice and an immersive activity on Optima's VR campus, and each module builds toward a Summative Assessment that shows what a scholar has mastered. The course is aligned to Florida's B.E.S.T. Standards for Mathematics and prepares scholars for the statewide Algebra 1 End-of-Course (EOC) assessment and for the mathematics that follows — geometry, higher algebra, statistics, and the quantitative reasoning of every STEM field.

WHAT SCHOLARS WILL LEARN TO DO

- Simplify and evaluate expressions using the laws of exponents, rational exponents, and radicals.
- Solve and model real-world problems with one-variable linear equations, inequalities, and absolute value equations.

- Graph and write linear functions and interpret their key features — slope, intercepts, and rate of change.
- Represent situations with two-variable linear inequalities and absolute value functions.
- Solve systems of linear equations and inequalities, and use constraints to model real decisions.
- Add, subtract, multiply, and factor polynomials, and solve quadratic equations by multiple methods.
- Analyze, graph, and write quadratic and exponential functions.
- Distinguish simple from compound interest and connect them to linear and exponential growth.
- Compare linear, quadratic, and exponential functions and describe the effects of transformations.
- Represent, analyze, and interpret data — scatter plots, surveys, and two-way frequency tables.

Big Assessments & Milestones

Target windows below follow a sample full-year pacing; On-Demand scholars pace to their own enrolled term and Live sections follow the class schedule, keeping each milestone roughly in order.

Milestone	Course place	Sample target	What you demonstrate
Quarter 1 Summatives	Modules 1–3 (start)	by Oct 9, 2026	Mastery of exponents & radicals, one-variable equations & inequalities, and graphing linear functions.
Quarter 2 Summatives (Semester 1 ends)	Modules 3–5	by Dec 18, 2026	Writing linear equations & scatter plots, linear/absolute-value inequalities, and systems.
Quarter 3 Summatives	Modules 6–8 (start)	by Mar 5, 2027	Polynomials & quadratics, quadratic functions, and exponential growth & decay.
Quarter 4 Summatives (Semester 2 ends)	Modules 8–11	by May 28, 2027	Exponential functions, analyzing & comparing functions, transformations, and statistical data.
Algebra 1 EOC (state end-of-course)	Cumulative	Spring testing window	A statewide, cumulative assessment of the Florida B.E.S.T. Algebra 1 standards. Your school confirms the exact date.

Important Dates — 2026–2027

Aug 12, 2026	First day of school	**Sep 7**	Holiday (Labor Day)
Oct 9	Quarter 1 ends	**Oct 12**	Holiday (Columbus Day)
Nov 11	Holiday (Veterans' Day)	**Nov 23–27**	Thanksgiving break

Dec 18	Quarter 2 ends · fall semester ends	**Dec 21–Jan 1**	Winter break
Jan 5, 2027	Classes resume	**Jan 18**	Holiday (MLK Day)
Feb 15	Holiday (Presidents' Day)	**Mar 5**	Quarter 3 ends
Mar 26–Apr 5	Spring break	**Apr 6**	Classes resume
May 28, 2027	Quarter 4 ends · last day of school	**May 31**	Holiday (Memorial Day)

Assessment & Grading

Course-design weighting for coursework. Your school or section may set official weights — your facilitator will confirm how the gradebook is set up for your section.

40%
Independent Practice & Mid-Module Checks

40%
Module Summative Assessments

20%
VR campus activities

Algebra 1 End-of-Course (EOC) exam

Algebra 1 is a state-tested course. Under Florida policy the statewide Algebra 1 EOC counts toward the final course grade (commonly 30%). Your school confirms the exact weight and testing window and how it is entered in Canvas.

How assignments work. Each lesson has an Independent Practice (about 4–10 problems). Each module has one or two Mid-Module Checks, a Summative Review (a completion grade, unlimited attempts), and a Summative Assessment (graded for correctness, two attempts). Independent Practices, Mid-Module Checks, and Summatives let scholars check each answer as they work — right or wrong, with a hint — and try again, so steady, honest practice is rewarded.

How This Course Is Delivered

This course is offered in two formats that share the same content, assignments, and expectations: an **On-Demand (asynchronous)** section you pace yourself, and a **Live (synchronous)** section that meets on a schedule on Optima's VR campus. Find the one that matches your enrollment.

On-Demand (asynchronous) learning

You move through the course at your own pace within each quarter, guided by due dates that keep you on track. All assignments for a quarter open at its start and close at its end. There is no grade penalty for missing an individual due date — but any assignment not completed by the end of the quarter receives a zero, and assignments submitted in the final 14 days of a quarter receive a 10% deduction, so steady pacing matters. Attendance is measured by assignment completion; per school policy, a scholar who completes no assignment for ten consecutive school days without notice may be dropped. Completion means a sincere attempt — real effort on real work. You are never on your own: a live facilitator grades your work, gives feedback, and hosts a weekly Study Hall and VR workshops.

Live (synchronous) learning

You join scheduled class meetings on Optima's VR campus, where your teacher leads instruction in real time and you learn alongside classmates. The lessons, assignments, and projects are the same as the On-Demand course; what differs is the pacing — a Live section moves through the material together, and class time is also used for discussion, questions, and guided practice. Attendance is measured by presence and participation. If you must miss a class, notify the school in advance; your teacher will help you make up the work.

Appropriate Use of AI

Optima scholars are preparing for a world shaped by artificial intelligence, and learning to use these tools with good judgment is part of that preparation. You are welcome to use AI tools to support your learning — to explain a concept a different way, check your understanding, or see a worked example — unless a particular assignment says otherwise. What AI may never do is the thinking or the work an assignment asks of you: solving the problems, showing the steps, or reasoning through a task must be genuinely your own. Submitting AI-generated work as your own is dishonest and counts as an insincere attempt. When you do use an AI tool on an assignment, say so briefly. Above all, build the underlying skill yourself — in mathematics the goal is to be able to judge whether an answer is right, which you can only do if you can do the work without it.

Learning in Virtual Reality

Optima is a virtual-reality school. Alongside your Canvas coursework, you will join immersive sessions on Optima's VR campus, where you meet teachers and fellow scholars, take part in live activities, and explore ideas in ways an ordinary classroom cannot. Keep your headset charged and ready for any scheduled VR sessions, and treat the VR campus with the same courtesy and seriousness you would a physical one. If you ever cannot get into VR for a session, tell your facilitator — there is an alternative way to take part so you do not fall behind.

Being an Optima Scholar

Optima's mission is an excellent, virtue-centered education, and virtue is at the center of this course as much as any other. Every scholar is expected to practice the seven virtues that shape life at Optima — **courage, courtesy, honesty, perseverance, self-government, service, and responsibility**. In practice that means: do

your own honest work; treat everyone you meet in, through, or because of this course with respect, in writing, in discussion, and in VR; engage actively rather than passively; come to Study Hall to get help and get to know your facilitator; and take responsibility for your own pacing and progress. You belong to a house and a community of scholars, not only to a course.

What You Need & Staying Connected

- ✓ A computer with reliable internet and access to **Canvas**.
- ✓ A **VR headset**, charged and ready for the immersive lesson activities on Optima's VR campus.
- ✓ A **calculator** — the course provides a State Assessment Online Calculator, and lessons use graphing tools (such as Desmos).
- ✓ The **Algebra 1 Reference Sheet** (in the Start Here! section), plus a notebook and pencils for working problems.
- ✓ **Microsoft 365** (Word, Excel) with OneDrive, for any documents you create and submit.

Staying connected. Updates about this course are posted on the course's Canvas page; school-wide updates are posted in your Homeroom Canvas course. Check both regularly. Your facilitator holds office hours and is glad to help with the material, to meet you, or to talk through your plans — come by, or reach out any time by email.

Algebra 1 · Florida course 1200310 · Full-year high-school course · Optima Academy Online, 2026–2027. Built from the course content (11 modules) and the board-approved 2026–2027 academic calendar. Aligned to the Florida B.E.S.T. Standards for Mathematics. Milestone target dates reflect a sample full-year pacing; On-Demand scholars pace to their own enrolled term. School calendar dates may be adjusted by the school.